Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠10

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠J

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥3

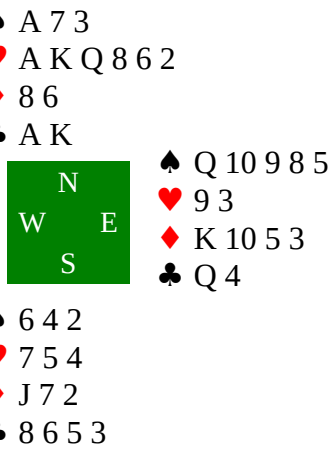
Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣A

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠7

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			

3♥ by North
Lead: ♠10

NORTH has 22 points and opens 2♣.

SOUTH is pretty weak, right? She responds 2♦.

NORTH bids his suit, 2♥.

SOUTH is so weak she bids the second negative - 3♣.

NORTH rebids his suit, 3♥, and SOUTH passes.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 9 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 8 7 ♣ A J 10 9 2	
♠ A K 6 3 ♥ A K 8 2 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q		♠ 4 2 ♥ Q J 9 7 5 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ 7 5 3
	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ 10 4 ♦ 9 6 4 3 ♣ 8 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by East
Lead: ♠J

WEST has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, EAST can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥suit.

WEST likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When EAST shows one Ace WEST bids 6♥.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 10 2 ♥ A Q J 10 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ K	
♠ 6 5 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q J 10 7 5 ♣ J 3 2	N W E S	♠ 7 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ 9 8 4 3 ♣ Q 10 9 6 5
	♠ A J 9 8 3 ♥ K 7 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A 8 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	7♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by South
Lead: ♥3

NORTH opens 2♣ and is pleased when SOUTH makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that SOUTH will pass.

SOUTH now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. NORTH continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for SOUTH to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 4 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ J 9 4 ♣ A J 9 7 4	
♠ A J 10 7 2 ♥ 9 8 7 ♦ 8 2 ♣ Q 5 3	N W E S	♠ K Q 8 6 ♥ A K J 2 ♦ A K Q ♣ 8 6
	♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 5 3 ♦ 10 7 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♣A

EAST has a minimum 2♣ opening.

WEST, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

EAST shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give WEST an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

WEST would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which EAST passes.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 6 3 ♥ Q 8 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ 9 5 3	
♠ 4 2 ♥ 10 9 4 3 ♦ Q J 2 ♣ K Q 10 2	N W E S	♠ J 10 8 7 5 ♥ J 7 6 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ 8 6
	♠ A Q 9 ♥ A K 2 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ A J 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠7

SOUTH, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But NORTH responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

SOUTH bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and NORTH passes.